

Maps and Environment – Social Notes

Introduction to Maps

A map is a drawing of the Earth's surface or a part of it on a flat surface. Maps help people understand locations, directions, distances, and geographical features. Maps are used in education, travel, weather forecasting, and planning.

Types of Maps

1. Physical Maps – Show mountains, rivers, deserts, and plains.
2. Political Maps – Show countries, states, capitals, and boundaries.
3. Thematic Maps – Show special information like rainfall, population, or climate.

Elements of a Map

- Title – Tells what the map is about.
- Scale – Shows the relationship between map distance and real distance.
- Symbols – Represent features like roads, schools, and hospitals.
- Direction – Usually shown with a north arrow or compass.

Map Type	Purpose
Physical Map	Shows landforms and water bodies
Political Map	Shows boundaries and cities
Thematic Map	Shows specific information

Environment and Society

The environment includes all living and non-living things around us such as air, water, soil, plants, and animals. Human life depends on a healthy environment for food, water, and shelter.

Importance of Environment

- Provides natural resources.
- Maintains ecological balance.
- Supports biodiversity and life on Earth.

Environmental Problems

1. Pollution – Air, water, and land pollution harm living beings.
2. Deforestation – Cutting trees causes loss of habitats and climate imbalance.
3. Global Warming – Increase in Earth's temperature due to greenhouse gases.
4. Waste Disposal – Improper disposal affects land and water quality.

Ways to Protect the Environment

- Plant more trees.
- Reduce plastic use.
- Save water and electricity.
- Practice recycling and reuse.
- Spread environmental awareness.

Conclusion

Maps help us understand the world, while environmental protection helps us preserve it. Both are important for sustainable development and social awareness.